



THE COMPLETE FIELD GUIDE

THE SIGNAL-BASED OUTBOUND PLAYBOOK

Find companies with a reason to buy. Turn fresh business events into relevant, credible outreach.

Built for B2B founders, agencies, consultants and revenue teams

Frameworks | Signal taxonomy | Scoring model | Outreach examples | QA checklist

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Outbound fails when timing is ignored.

Most teams build lists using industry, company size and job title. Those filters identify fit, but they do not explain why a prospect should care today.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

A company can fit your ideal customer profile perfectly and still have no active reason to buy. Signal-based outbound adds a second decision layer: recent changes that may create urgency, budget, operational pressure or a new strategic priority.

ICP FIT

Who could buy

BUYING SIGNAL

Why they may care now

MANUAL QA

Whether the angle is credible

What this playbook covers

- 01 The signal-based outbound model**
How fit, timing, evidence and relevance work together.
- 02 Buying-signal taxonomy**
Ten commercial signals and what each may indicate.
- 03 Signal qualification**
Freshness, strength, evidence and false-positive control.
- 04 Building a signal-based ICP**
Company, signal and contact fit.
- 05 The Why Now framework**
Turn an event into a commercially relevant hypothesis.
- 06 Opportunity scoring**
A practical 100-point prioritisation model.
- 07 Contact and account research**
Find the correct person without overclaiming.
- 08 Writing signal-led outreach**
Email structures, examples and follow-ups.
- 09 Manual QA and governance**
Quality gates, uncertainty flags and rejection rules.
- 10 Implementation plan**
A 30-day rollout and operating checklist.

The signal-based outbound model

Signal-based outbound does not replace ICP targeting. It adds a prioritisation layer that determines which accounts deserve attention first.

1

FIT

Does the account match the market, size, region and business model?

2

CHANGE

Has something commercially relevant happened recently?

3

IMPACT

Could that event create a problem, priority or budget?

4

PERSON

Who owns the likely outcome?

5

MESSAGE

Can the connection be stated credibly in one or two sentences?

Ten commercially useful signals

A signal matters only when it has a plausible relationship to the service you sell. The event is evidence; the buying implication remains a hypothesis.

Sales hiring

Pipeline investment and capacity expansion

Funding

New budget and growth expectations

Leadership change

New priorities and vendor reviews

Product launch

Need for distribution and demand creation

Geographic expansion

New-market entry and localisation

Technology change

Implementation or integration pressure

Pricing change

Commercial repositioning

Customer wins

Delivery capacity and category momentum

Compliance change

Mandatory process or tooling upgrades

Public pain signal

Visible operational or growth problem

Signals in practice - growth events

Four common triggers, aligned to the business implication and the right owner.

Sales hiring

MEANING	Multiple SDR, BDR, AE or sales-leadership openings may indicate a planned increase in outbound capacity.
LIKELY OWNER	Founder, VP Sales, Head of Growth, RevOps
ANGLE	You are expanding the sales team. Teams at this stage often need qualified accounts before new reps are fully productive.

Funding

MEANING	A newly funded company may have more budget, higher growth expectations and pressure to deploy capital.
LIKELY OWNER	Founder, CRO, VP Growth
ANGLE	Following the round, the team appears to be entering a faster growth phase. We identified accounts showing current demand signals.

Leadership change

MEANING	A new executive may reassess strategy, vendors, processes and performance expectations.
LIKELY OWNER	New functional leader or founder
ANGLE	A new revenue leader often reviews pipeline quality, targeting and outbound operations during the first quarter.

Product launch

MEANING	A new product, feature or category creates an immediate need for positioning, distribution and demand creation.
LIKELY OWNER	Founder, Product Marketing, Growth, Sales
ANGLE	The launch gives your team a reason to approach a new buyer group. We mapped companies showing relevant current triggers.

Signals in practice - operational events

Geographic expansion

MEANING Entering a new region requires local account coverage, messaging and market-specific evidence.

LIKELY OWNER Founder, Regional GM, VP Sales

ANGLE Your UK expansion suggests a need for a market-specific pipeline rather than a recycled global list.

Technology change

MEANING CRM, security, AI or analytics changes may create migration, integration and enablement requirements.

LIKELY OWNER CTO, CIO, RevOps, Operations

ANGLE The recent platform migration may create workflow and data-quality gaps during implementation.

Pricing or packaging change

MEANING A new tier or enterprise plan may signal a shift in target market and sales motion.

LIKELY OWNER Founder, Revenue leader, Product Marketing

ANGLE The new enterprise package changes who should be targeted and how value must be framed.

Compliance change

MEANING New obligations can create deadlines, budget and executive attention.

LIKELY OWNER Compliance, Security, Legal, Operations

ANGLE The upcoming requirement may force teams to review current controls before the deadline.

Not every signal deserves outreach

Apply four tests before treating an event as commercially actionable.

FRESHNESS

How recently did the event occur?

- 0-14 days: strong
- 15-30 days: usable
- 31-60 days: weak
- 60+ days: usually stale

RELEVANCE

Does the event connect directly to your offer?

- Direct impact: strong
- Adjacent impact: review
- Generic growth: weak

EVIDENCE

Can the event be verified?

- Primary source: best
- Reputable secondary source: usable
- Unverified inference: reject

SPECIFICITY

Can you explain the likely impact clearly?

- Specific operational effect: strong
- Broad assumption: weak
- No plausible effect: reject

RULE

When evidence is uncertain, label it as uncertain. Never present inference as fact.

Build a three-layer ICP

A useful ICP defines the company, the changes that matter and the people who own the resulting outcome.

COMPANY FIT

- Industry and business model
- Geography
- Employee range
- Estimated deal value
- Growth stage
- Existing sales motion

SIGNAL FIT

- Signal type
- Freshness window
- Minimum evidence quality
- Required relevance
- Exclusions
- Confidence threshold

CONTACT FIT

- Department
- Seniority
- Ownership of outcome
- Decision authority
- Regional responsibility
- Fallback role

EXAMPLE

B2B SaaS | US/UK | 11-100 employees | ACV above \$5k | hiring sales roles within 14 days | contact Founder or VP Sales.

The Why Now framework

The objective is not to claim buying intent. It is to establish a credible reason the conversation may be relevant now.

1

WHAT CHANGED?

State the verified event without exaggeration.

2

WHAT MAY IT AFFECT?

Identify the likely operational, revenue or strategic impact.

3

WHY ARE YOU RELEVANT?

Connect your service to that specific impact.

4

WHY ACT NOW?

Explain the cost of delay or value of timely action.

FORMULA

Observed event + likely impact + relevant solution
= credible outreach angle

A practical 100-point model

The score is a prioritisation aid, not proof of intent. Keep the evidence visible so reviewers can challenge the result.

CATEGORY	WEIGHT	WHAT TO EVALUATE
ICP fit	30	Industry, size, region, business model and commercial fit
Signal relevance	25	How directly the event relates to the offer
Signal freshness	20	Recency adjusted for the significance of the event
Decision-maker fit	15	Ownership, seniority and authority
Evidence confidence	10	Source quality and certainty

80-100

HIGH PRIORITY

60-79

MANUAL REVIEW

BELOW 60

DO NOT CONTACT

Research the account and the person

Good research is concise, source-aware and decision-oriented. The goal is to decide whether the account should be contacted.

ACCOUNT EVIDENCE

- Official announcement or careers page
- Relevant product or pricing page
- Company size and region
- Commercial-fit evidence
- Date and source URL

PERSON EVIDENCE

- Correct functional ownership
- Current title and tenure
- Regional or product scope
- Professional contact path
- Fallback contact

UNCERTAINTY FLAGS

- Unclear employee count
- Signal date not confirmed
- Catch-all email domain
- Title may be outdated
- Impact is inferred

DO NOT

Treat a catch-all email as verified, infer personal details, or state that a company is ready to buy.

Write signal-led outreach

Use the signal to establish relevance, not to perform research theatre. Keep the observation factual and the implication modest.

1

OBSERVATION

Mention the verified event in one sentence.

2

IMPLICATION

Describe a likely business effect using cautious language.

3

RELEVANCE

State how your service addresses that effect.

4

PROOF

Add one concise credibility point.

5

CTA

Ask a low-friction, relevant question.

RECOMMENDED LENGTH**60-110 words****One signal | One commercial implication | One clear CTA**

Three outreach examples

SALES HIRING

SUBJECT: Building pipeline for the new sales hires

Hi Maya,

I noticed the team is hiring several account executives. When headcount grows before account-research capacity, new reps can spend too much time finding companies rather than starting conversations.

Frithly identifies accounts showing recent buying signals and manually reviews the Why Now before delivery.

Would a sample of five relevant accounts be useful?

PRODUCT LAUNCH

SUBJECT: Targeting around the new product

Hi Daniel,

The new enterprise product gives your team a reason to approach a different buyer group. The challenge is identifying which companies have a current event that makes the launch relevant now.

We research those signals and pair them with the appropriate decision-maker.

Open to seeing a small example for your market?

GEOGRAPHIC EXPANSION

SUBJECT: UK account timing

Hi Priya,

I saw that the company is expanding into the UK. Reusing a broad global list usually misses local timing and context.

Frithly builds market-specific account lists around recent hiring, launches, leadership changes and expansion activity, then manually checks each account.

Should I send a short sample?

A simple four-touch sequence

Follow-ups should add context rather than repeat just checking in. Stop when the signal becomes stale or the account no longer fits.

1

DAY 1 | INITIAL

Signal + likely impact + relevance + CTA

2

DAY 4 | FOLLOW-UP 1

Add one useful observation or example

3

DAY 8 | FOLLOW-UP 2

Clarify who the service is best suited for

4

DAY 14 | CLOSE

Offer the sample or close the loop respectfully

The manual QA gate

Manual review is the control layer between automated discovery and client-facing delivery.



Company matches the defined ICP



Signal is verified and dated



Signal is recent enough for the event type



Commercial relevance is plausible



Correct decision-maker is identified



Contact status is represented accurately



Why Now explanation is specific



Outreach claim does not exceed evidence



Uncertainty flags are visible



Reviewer can explain why the lead was approved

Reject early to protect quality

A smaller defensible list is more valuable than a larger list built on weak assumptions.

NO ICP FIT

Wrong industry, region, size or commercial model.

STALE SIGNAL

The event is too old to justify current outreach.

WEAK CONNECTION

The signal does not plausibly relate to the offer.

NO SOURCE

The event cannot be verified.

WRONG PERSON

The contact does not own the likely outcome.

UNSAFE CLAIM

The message would present inference as fact.

CONTACT RISK

Email or phone status cannot be represented honestly.

GENERIC ANGLE

The same message could be sent to any company.

A 30-day rollout plan

Start with one narrow segment and one or two strong signals. Expand only after review consistently produces defensible approvals.

WEEK 1

DEFINE

- Choose one ICP
- Choose two signals
- Set freshness rules
- Define rejection criteria

WEEK 2

BUILD

- Collect 30-50 candidates
- Record sources and dates
- Identify POC roles
- Draft Why Now hypotheses

WEEK 3

REVIEW

- Score all accounts
- Run manual QA
- Track rejection reasons
- Refine thresholds

WEEK 4

LAUNCH

- Approve first cohort
- Write tailored outreach
- Track replies and objections
- Update the framework

SUCCESS METRIC

Percentage of delivered accounts that pass QA and generate positive replies - not raw list volume.

Signal-qualified account worksheet

Use one page per account during research or review.

COMPANY

DOMAIN

INDUSTRY

LOCATION / SIZE

VERIFIED SIGNAL

SIGNAL DATE AND SOURCE

DECISION-MAKER AND ROLE

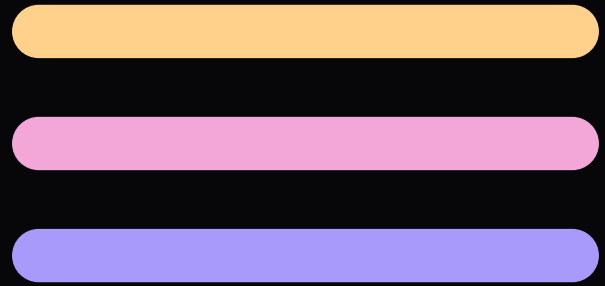
SCORE / 100

LIKELY BUSINESS IMPACT

WHY NOW STATEMENT

UNCERTAINTY FLAGS

REVIEWER DECISION



See the framework applied to your market.

Frithly identifies companies showing commercially relevant changes, matches them against your ICP, finds the appropriate decision-makers and manually reviews every account before delivery.

NEXT STEP

Request a sample signal-qualified account list

See the evidence, Why Now reasoning and outreach angles before committing.

VISIT FRITHLY.COM

Quality, timing and context over bulk lead volume.

